



CRAB-KILLING OCTOPUS

The most well-known of the cephalopods, octopuses often live in seabed crevices. They emerge to seek out prey such as crabs, which they rip apart with their eight suckered arms. Unlike cuttlefish and squid, they do not have an extra pair of tentacles. They are remarkably intelligent and quick to learn.

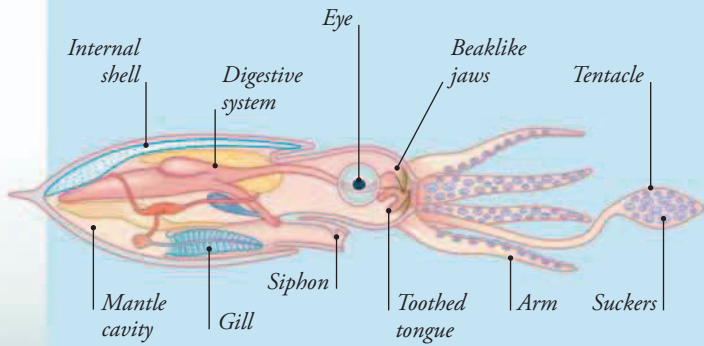
◀ TOXIC TERROR

Some octopuses kill their prey with a venomous bite. The venom of the tiny tropical blue-ringed octopus is incredibly toxic and can kill a human within a few minutes.



INSIDE A CEPHALOPOD

The word cephalopod means "head-limb." It describes the way the arms are attached directly to the animal's head, surrounding its mouth. The mouth has beaklike jaws and a toothed tongue. The eight flexible arms are equipped with rows of suckers, and squid and cuttlefish also have a pair of extendible tentacles.



INKY DEFENSE

Feeling threatened by an approaching diver, a giant octopus squirts a cloud of dark ink into the water from its siphon tube. The ink billows out in the water like dense smoke, allowing the octopus to escape as it shoots backward through the water at high speed. Squid and cuttlefish also use this same inky defense tactic.

